

DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2020–21



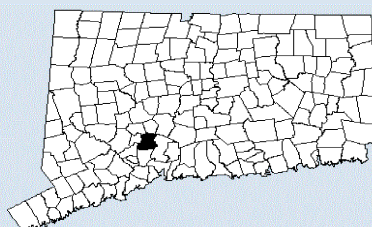
Bethany School District

Ms. Colleen Murray, Superintendent • 203-393-1170 • <http://www.bethany-ed.org>

District Information

Grade Range	PK-6
Number of Schools/Programs	1
Enrollment	370
Per Pupil Expenditures ¹	\$19,132
Total Expenditures ¹	\$7,212,710

¹ Expenditure data reflect the 2019-20 school year.



Community Information

[AdvanceCT Town Profiles](#) provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities

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Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2020-21 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality, or to ensure that statistics based on a very small sample size are not interpreted as equally representative as those based on a sufficiently larger sample size.

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

Students

October 1, 2020 Enrollment²

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
Female	178	48.1	48.4
Male	192	51.9	51.5
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	0.3
Asian	19	5.1	5.2
Black or African American	*	*	12.7
Hispanic or Latino of any race	36	9.7	27.8
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	7	1.9	4.0
White	301	81.4	49.9
English Learners	12	3.2	8.3
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	50	13.5	42.7
Students with Disabilities ³	53	14.3	16.3

NOTE: To protect student privacy, gender counts are suppressed (*) when fewer than 6 students enrolled in the district identify as non-binary.

² This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

³ Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

	Chronic Absenteeism ⁴		Suspension/Expulsion ⁵	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	13	7.4	0	0.0
Male	10	5.6	*	*
Black or African American	0	*	0	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	*	*	0	0.0
White	16	5.6	*	*
English Learners	*	*	0	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	14	29.2	*	*
Students with Disabilities	*	*	*	*
District	23	6.5	*	*
State		19.0		1.4

Number of students in 2019-20 qualified as truant under state statute: 24

Number of school-based arrests: 0

NOTE: In the 2020-21 school year, students attended school in-person to varying degrees; some learned fully/mostly remotely for the entire school year. Chronic absenteeism calculations are based only on in-person school days.

⁴ A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

⁵ This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

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Educators

Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)¹ Staff

	FTE
General Education	
Teachers and Instructors	29.0
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	0.0
Special Education	
Teachers and Instructors	6.0
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	12.0
Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs	
District Central Office	2.0
School Level	1.0
Library/Media	
Specialists (Certified)	1.0
Support Staff	0.4
Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers	3.6
Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists	3.0
School Nurses	1.8
Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support	22.7

¹ In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

Educators by Race/Ethnicity

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
American Indian or Alaska Native	0	0.0	0.1
Asian	0	0.0	1.3
Black or African American	1	2.2	4.1
Hispanic or Latino of any race	0	0.0	4.3
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	1	2.2	0.1
White	44	95.7	89.9

Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2019-20

	District	State
Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time	11.1	7.3

Instruction and Resources

Students with Disabilities Who Spend 79.1 to 100 Percent of Time with Nondisabled Peers²

	Count	Rate (%)
Autism	*	*
Emotional Disturbance	0	0
Intellectual Disability	0	0
Learning Disability	10	*
Other Health Impairment	*	*
Other Disabilities	0	0
Speech/Language Impairment	8	*
District	27	69.2
State		67.9

² This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

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Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability¹

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Autism	6	1.7	2.1
Emotional Disturbance	*	*	1.1
Intellectual Disability	*	*	0.5
Learning Disability	13	3.6	5.8
Other Health Impairment	*	*	3.3
Other Disabilities	6	1.7	1.2
Speech/Language Impairment	13	3.6	1.9
All Disabilities	47	13.2	15.9

¹ This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District²

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Public Schools in Other Districts	*	*	8.3
Private Schools or Other Settings	*	*	4.8

² This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Overall Expenditures³: 2019-20

	Total (\$)	Per Pupil	
		District (\$)	State (\$)
Instruction	\$4,500,653	\$11,938	\$11,205
Support services - students	\$189,005	\$512	\$1,346
Support services - instruction	\$257,294	\$697	\$698
Support services - general administration	\$729,597	\$1,977	\$464
Support services - school based administration	\$295,523	\$801	\$1,037
Central and other support services	\$254	\$1	\$691
Operation and maintenance of plant	\$806,898	\$2,187	\$1,692
Student transportation services	\$418,432	\$1,295	\$1,159
Food services	.	.	\$21
Enterprise operations	\$15,054	\$41	\$151
Total	\$7,212,710	\$19,132	\$17,838

³ Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

Special Education Expenditures: 2019-20

	District		State
	Total (\$)	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Teacher Salaries	\$653,522	32.6	29.6
Instructional Aide Salaries	\$260,913	13.0	11.1
Other Salaries	\$236,291	11.8	9.5
Employee Benefits	\$218,439	10.9	13.5
Purchased Services Other Than Transportation	\$122,889	6.1	5.4
Special Education Tuition	\$182,093	9.1	22.5
Supplies	\$7,095	0.4	0.5
Property Services	.	.	0.3
Purchased Services For Transportation	.	.	7.2
Equipment	\$159,774	8.0	0.2
All Other Expenditures	\$165,171	8.2	0.1
Total	\$2,006,187	100.0	100.0
Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education		27.8	25.1

Expenditures by Revenue Source⁴: 2019-20

	Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction
Local	83.1
State	14.1
Federal	2.2
Tuition & Other	0.6

⁴ Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

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Performance and Accountability

District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, no table is shown here. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient¹

READING	NAEP 2019		NAEP 2013
	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
Connecticut	40	41	50
National Public	34	32	36
MATH	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
Connecticut	45	39	32
National Public	40	33	25

¹ NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2019.pdf

Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, no table is shown here. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

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Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, a modified table is shown below. All indicators that were not calculated for the 2020-21 school year (including overall Accountability Index) have been excluded and columns that referenced points have also been removed to avoid confusion. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

Indicator		Index/Rate	Target	State Average Index/Rate
Chronic Absenteeism	All Students	6.5%	<=5%	19.0%
	High Needs Students	17.5%	<=5%	30.2%
Preparation for CCR	% Taking Courses	.	75%	80.6%
	% Passing Exams	N/A	75%	36.0%
On-track to High School Graduation		.	94%	84.5%
4-year Graduation All Students (2020 Cohort)		.	94%	88.8%
6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2018 Cohort)		.	94%	85.2%
Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2020)		.	75%	67.4%
Arts Access		.	60%	50.7%

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Gap Indicators	Non-High Needs Rate ¹	High Needs Rate	Size of Gap	State Gap Mean +1 Stdev ²	Is Gap an Outlier? ²
Graduation Rate Gap	.	.	.	.	.

¹ If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

² If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, no SIMR data are available. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

Supporting Resources:

Two-page FAQ at http://edsight.ct.gov/relatedreports/nextgenFAQ_revisedDec2018.pdf

Detailed Presentation at https://edsight.ct.gov/relatedreports/Next%20Generation%20Accountability%20System_Detailed%20Presentation_Jan_2020.pdf

Using Accountability Results to Guide Improvement at https://edsight.ct.gov/relatedreports/Using_Accountability_Results_to_Guide_Improvement.pdf

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Narratives

School District Improvement Plans and Parental Outreach Activities

The Bethany Public School District is committed to supporting the family's role in the education of their students. This year, due to the pandemic, many of our traditional methods of engaging families were not possible. Because of this, we employed several new programs and revised others where possible. First, a community liaison and volunteer coordinator continues to be a point of contact for families who wish to support students. Because we were not able to have volunteers come into the school, families were invited to participate in virtual opportunities, sharing their heritage, careers, and expertise with students. Traditional showcases of student work like our annual Night of the Arts were recreated digitally and shared with families. Teachers maintain web pages, Google Classroom sites, and share newsletters to keep families informed of classroom activities and information regarding homework and how to access learning resources from home. The Principal implemented a weekly email newsletter to families with updates and information for future events. The Principal held bi-weekly Principal Coffee Hours over Zoom to share topics and engage in dialogue with families. The Superintendent, along with the Board of Education (BOE) Chair, and the Principal submits a monthly article to the Bethany Bulletin to keep the community informed on school-related events and issues impacting education. The superintendent also shares a weekly COVID update with the community to keep them informed of all relevant legislation, policies, and impacts of COVID on the school. Administration present at monthly BOE meetings. They also partner with the BOE to host two "Community Open Forums." Parents and members of the community are active members of the Strategic Planning Committee, Wellness Council, School Lunch Advisory Board, and Equity Team. Each spring, parents are encouraged to provide the District with feedback and input through surveys. Families were also given the opportunity to give feedback on Remote Learning in the fall. The feedback from these surveys is used to develop goals for the District/School Improvement Plans.

To support Remote Learning families, Bethany Community School utilized staff as Remote Learning Support Teachers. These staff worked with families and students to answer any questions they had regarding assignments or technology. Additionally, the teachers set individual and small group sessions to support students and families.

The District continues to utilize the Climate Committee, Student Support, and Truancy Committee to support families by taking an active role in monitoring student attendance, identifying chronic absenteeism, and truancy as well as other wellness topics. The District has established partnerships with local agencies to support families in need.

The District continues to prioritize collaboration between classroom teachers and special educators to improve learning for identified students. They meet regularly to discuss strategies for instruction, analysis of data, and behavior management techniques. A Life Skills Program is fully staffed with a dedicated special education teacher, paraprofessionals, and a behaviorist to support students requiring this programming. The District continued to offer a Unified Sports program to promote social inclusion between identified students and their non-identified peers.

Efforts to Reduce Racial, Ethnic and Economic Isolation

The Bethany Public School District provides numerous opportunities for students and teachers to interact with those from diverse racial, ethnic, and economic backgrounds. The District participates in several regional programs offered by Area Cooperative Educational Services (ACES). Bethany participates in the Open Choice Program whereby five students from New Haven attend the Bethany Community School (BCS).

BCS offers scheduled enrichment activities that highlight language, arts, folklore, traditions, customs, and lifestyles of diverse populations. Multicultural curriculum resources are purchased to complement units of study and classroom libraries. These resources are also utilized during morning meetings and social-emotional learning activities to promote empathy and understanding of diverse perspectives in all students. To address the economic disparities across the community, the school partners with the PTO as well as other local organizations to provide support for those that are experiencing hardship so that all students can participate in activities and events. The school also works with local organizations and ACES to support both local community and New Haven County families during the Thanksgiving and winter holidays.

This year, BCS established an Equity Team consisting of Board of Education members, families, staff, administration, and community members. The Equity Team is focused on supporting diverse resources in the school, creating its own mission statement, and developing a diversity and inclusion statement for potential adoption by the District. Additionally, the District is committed to providing professional development to all staff around equity and diversity on an ongoing basis, bringing in outside presenters from the Capitol Region Education Council (CREC).

Through Human Resources' efforts, the District strives to recruit and retain highly qualified staff that represent the diversity in our classrooms. The percentage of minority staff employed by the Bethany Public School district has increased by 7% over the last five years. The District partners with the Anti-Defamation League to offer workshops for students and staff in grades 4-6 to address bias, discrimination, tolerance, and sensitivity.

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Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools

Bethany is a one school district.